

KIMBERLY (KIM) BELL

SENIOR SOFTWARE DEVELOPMENT ENGINEER IN TEST (SDET)

Quality Platform Engineering | Test Architecture | CI/CD Release Confidence

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior SDET with 8+ years spanning frontend engineering and quality-platform leadership. Progressed from building React applications to owning a shared Cypress/Typescript automation platform used by 10 engineering teams across 35 repositories. Turned regression testing into a repeatable release capability by integrating suites into GitLab CI/CD, reducing hardening from hours to minutes, and serving as the escalation point for flaky or ambiguous failures. Recent work extends the same evidence-first approach into Playwright and AI-assisted QA tooling.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Career Sabbatical - Medical leave; Available for full-time roles.

Jan 2024 - Nov 2025

Ally Financial, Charlotte, NC

Dec 2018 - Dec 2023

Senior SDET (Remote)

Jan 2022 - Dec 2023

Promoted from feature engineer after becoming Ally's Cypress subject-matter expert during the Ember-to-React migration. Owned the shared web-automation platform and responsible for tackling any blockers to ensure the 2-week release cycles consistently met.

- Led transition from 100% manual to 90% automated testing across 10 teams in 2 years using Cypress, Testing Library, TypeScript, and Gitlab CI/CD, reducing regression effort and enabling consistent 2-week release cycles
- Designed and scaled Typescript/Cypress test automation used by 10 engineering teams; expanded adoption from 11 to 35 repositories by standardizing automation practices and framework adoption
- Integrated UI automation into Gitlab CI/CD pipelines, reducing release hardening from hours to minutes and keeping sprint deployments on schedule
- Built and scaled reusable Cypress (with Testing Library) commands and guardrails for API completion, feature flags, and contract-dependent behavior, reducing repetitive manual test processing by 75% while improving suite consistency
- Served as the primary escalation point for flaky and ambiguous failures; separated product defects from automation, network, and environment issues and coordinated fixes with owning teams
- Led QA platform team's Jira board migration from Kanban to Agile sprints, leveraging feature team experience to bridge both workflows and align QA cadence with feature team sprint cycles, reducing cross-team friction

Software Engineer

Dec 2018 - Dec 2021

Built web features during Ally's critical Ember-to-React migration, then expanded ownership into test modernization.

The Cypress proof of concept, training, and shared patterns established in this role became the technical path into QA-platform leadership.

- Delivered and validated frontend web features across Ember and React using Jest, BrowserStack, Swagger, and Voiceover before QA handoff
- Championed Cypress adoption by participating in the proof of concept, then lead training and established foundational patterns that became the organization's shared approach
- Migrated automated tests alongside React architecture changes, preserving regression protection during the platform transition
- Created API mocks and traced UI failures to contract changes using Swagger for validation

Reason Consulting Corporation, Charlotte, NC**Oct 2015 - Nov 2018**

previously Tax Management Associates

Software Engineer**Jan 2018 - Nov 2018****Junior Frontend Developer / Apprentice****Oct 2015 - Dec 2017**

Advanced from apprentice to Software Engineer while building production React applications and helping designers translate interface concepts into implementation.

- Built 2 production React applications from requirements through user-facing delivery
- Trained UI/UX designers in React, reducing friction between design handoff and production development

CONTINUOUS LEARNING & PROJECTS

Independent Study & Projects**Dec 2025 - July 2026****QA/SDET Claude Code Plugin** github.com/TzolkinB/skills

- Individual and orchestration layer of 10+ QA/SDET Claude Code skills enforcing the principal that “a green test is not proof”
- Skills include mutation-based test auditing, E2E test-impact analysis, and flake/drift triage for the Playwright/Cypress domain
- Validated blind against a third-party app with an evidence-provenance standard, contract-guard, and calibrated release gate in progress

Playwright Test Collection - github.com/TzolkinB/playwright-test-collection

- Migrated an existing Cypress suite to Playwright with Typescript, and Github Actions
- Used Github Copilot to accelerate test code generation and debug test failures
- Covers UI integration tests and REST API tests, with shared fixtures and helper abstractions to eliminate duplication across spec files

LoopQA Playwright Suite - github.com/TzolkinB/loop-playwright

- [LoopQA](#): Built a data-driven Playwright test suite using the Page Object Model (POM), JSON data, Typescript enums, a reusable authentication setup, responsive web/mobile tests, and designed for scalability
- Separated scenario data from test logic so new cases can be added through data files with requiring changes to the test code

SKILLS

Languages & Frameworks: JavaScript, Typescript, React**Testing:** Playwright, Cypress, Jest, Testing Library, E2E, Integration, Regression, API, Accessibility, Responsive, SQL**CI/CD & Tools:** Github Copilot, Git, Gitlab CI/CD, Github Actions, Bitbucket, BrowserStack, LogRocket, Jira, Confluence, qTest, Claude Code**EDUCATION**

Master of Arts (MA), International Human Rights - University of Denver, Denver, CO**Bachelor of Arts (BA), Anthropology** - North Carolina State University, Raleigh, NC